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Deputy Director Cyber Security

UK Health Security Agency

Apply before 11:55 pm on Wednesday 29th July 2026



Reference number

467668

Salary

£130,000

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

SCS Pay Band 1

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

Chief Data Officer Group, Trusted Data & Technology Directorate

Type of role

Other

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Birmingham, Leeds, Liverpool, London

About the job

Job summary

UKHSA has an exciting opportunity for a Deputy Director of Cyber Security to strengthen its capability in protecting digital assets. Working closely with internal teams and key stakeholders (Government Security Group, NCSC, CPNI), the role will help build a resilient infrastructure that supports UKHSA's ambition to become a global leader in health security and a critical component of national security.

You will be part of the Chief Data Officer (CDO) Group senior leadership team, which brings together Trusted Data & Technology, Data & Digital, and Analysis & Intelligence Assessment. The Group harnesses data, safeguards systems, and supports integrated analysis to assess health risks, inform policy, and protect public health.

The Trusted Data & Technology Directorate (TDT) delivers impact by transforming the UK's approach to public health data, analytics, and surveillance. It comprises four divisions: Information Management & Privacy, Data Strategy & Performance, Technology, and Cyber Security.

As Deputy Director Cyber Security, reporting to the Director of TDT, you will lead and develop an effective, resilient cyber function that protects UKHSA from threats. The role involves leading a mixed team of civil servants and managed service providers, embedding a strong security culture, maintaining robust incident response, and ensuring long-term resilience of networks, systems, and data. You will also manage the division's budget and contracts, operating in a fast-paced environment with competing priorities.

You will contribute to wider senior leadership, supporting an inclusive culture and playing a strong corporate role across UKHSA.

Job description

Key responsibilities

- Lead and motivate cyber security teams (civil servants and contractors).

Horizon-scan and plan for emerging cyber threats in collaboration with NHS England, NCSC, CPNI, and other government bodies.

Promote a strong security culture across UKHSA.

Develop cyber capability within the team and wider organisation.

Ensure robust, tested resilience and incident response plans.

Embed 'secure by design' principles across systems and programmes.

Develop metrics to inform SIRO governance and risk management.

Oversee budget, contracts, and financial accountability in line with public sector standards.

Reporting Responsibilities

Reporting to the Director of Trusted Data & Technology, you will:

Develop and mature UKHSA's cyber security function.

Lead a team of around 42 staff and managed services partners.

Support compliance programmes (e.g. DSPT-CAF).

Act as senior cyber advisor to the UKHSA SIRO, contributing to governance and risk escalation.

Provide balanced advice across operational, information, IT, and supply chain security.

Manage responses to cyber threats impacting services and data.

Oversee delegated budgets and commercial processes.

You will need to stay current with a rapidly evolving technical landscape and maintain strong relationships across government and industry

Person specification

It is important through your CV and Statement of Suitability that you provide evidence and examples of proven experience of these Essential selection criteria.

Cyber Security Expertise

Proven cyber security professional with the credibility to engage technical

audiences. Strong practical cyber knowledge, supported by relevant qualifications where applicable.

Leadership

Exceptional people leader with a proven track record of building, leading, and developing diverse security teams, supporting both organisational goals and individual career growth.

Influencing & Stakeholder Management

Highly effective communicator with strong stakeholder management skills, able to influence at senior levels and build trusted relationships across internal and external partners.

Decision-Making & Problem Solving

Able to navigate complex challenges in a fast-changing environment, drawing on expertise from others to manage risk and make sound decisions at pace.

Risk, Compliance & Governance

Strong understanding of cyber security legal and regulatory requirements, including GDPR and NIS. Able to balance threats and mitigations to provide clear, risk-based recommendations.

Commercial & Financial Acumen

Strong commercial and financial awareness, with a proven ability to drive efficiency and deliver value for money.

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £130,000, UK Health Security Agency contributes £37,661 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\).](#)

Learning and development tailored to your role

An environment with flexible working options

A culture encouraging inclusion and diversity

A [Civil Service pension](#) with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

To apply for this post, you will need to complete the online application process, outlined below. This should be completed no later than **23:55 Wednesday 29th July 2026**.

1. A CV (which is for information purposes only) setting out your career history, with key responsibilities and achievements. Please ensure you have provided reasons for any gaps within the last two years.
2. A Statement of Suitability (**no more than 1250 words**) explaining how you consider your personal skills, qualities and experience provide evidence of your suitability for the role, with particular reference to the criteria in the person specification.

Failure to complete both documents will mean the panel only have limited information on which to assess your application against the criteria in the person specification.

UKHSA will be holding an informal information session via MTeams on Monday 13th July between 13:30 to 14:00 for potential applicants to find out more about the role of Deputy Director Cyber Security. Whether you are contemplating an application or simply want more insight into the role and its potential impact, this session will provide you with a much better understanding of the environment, expectations and ambitions of DSIT's digital and AI agendas.

Please email scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk by 17:00 on Sunday 12th July 2026 to register your interest in attending. UKHSA will then send you an MSTeams invite.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

This role has a minimum assignment duration of 3 years. An assignment duration is the period of time a Senior Civil Servant is expected to remain in the same post to enable them to deliver on the agreed key business outcomes. The assignment duration also supports your career through building your depth of expertise.

As part of accepting this role you will be agreeing to the expected assignment duration set out above. This will not result in a contractual change to your terms and conditions. Please note this is an expectation only, it is not something which is written into your terms and conditions or indeed which the employing organisation or you are bound by. It will depend on your personal circumstances at a particular time and business needs, for example, would not preclude any absence like family friendly leave. It is nonetheless an important expectation, which is why we ask you to confirm you agree to the assignment duration set out above.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [developed vetting \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

Open to UK nationals only.

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : SCS Recruitment Team

Email : scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : scscandidate.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Civil Service
Commission

